Habibou Ibrahim Kassoum

Economist | AI & Data Scientist | Statistician

Location: *Clermont-Ferrand, France;* ***Citizenship:*** *Nigerien;* ***Birth date:*** *November 13th, 1998 (27 years).*

Phone | Email | Portfolio | GitHub | LinkedIn

Profile Summary

Current position: Ph.D. Research Fellow in Development Economics.

Work experience countries: France, Malawi, Mauritania, Senegal, Uganda, United States of America.

Languages: English (fluent), French (native), Hausa (native), Zarma (native).

Interests: causal inference, impact evaluation, machine learning, AI and data science, poverty alleviation and welfare measurement.

Applied microeconomist with 4+ years of experience producing rigorous economic research and impact evaluation in support of multilateral institutions, including the World Bank, across developing countries in Sub-Saharan Africa. Strong quantitative and analytical skills in causal inference, machine learning and AI, using reproducible workflows in Python, R, Stata and SQL. Proven ability to build client capacity in the field, training economists and statistical-office staff while deploying decision-support tools for government counterparts.

Work Experience

Poverty & Equity Global Practice, Eastern & Southern Africa – The World Bank

Washington, D.C., USA

Economist – Data Scientist (STC)

Jun. 2025 – Jul. 2026

Contributed to the **$15 million** Malawi Statistical Capacity Building Project (STATCAP). Built **analytical poverty models** and a **microsimulation** web application to inform targeting and fiscal policy decisions by government counterparts.

- Revised Malawi's national poverty line via micro- and macro-level analysis of household consumption data, refining diagnostics for 19 million people and improving targeting of $100 million in social transfers.
- Developed, tested and deployed an interactive microsimulation web application enabling policymakers to simulate poverty and inequality impacts of tax and transfer reforms, supporting evidence-based fiscal policy.
- Built client capacity through in-country workshops for 35 economists across 3 Malawian ministries on microsimulation and fiscal incidence, enabling them to run their own distributional analysis of fiscal reforms.

Africa Gender Innovation Lab (GIL) – The World Bank

Washington, D.C., USA

Economist – Data Scientist (STC)

Feb. 2025 – Jul. 2026

Supported the **impact evaluation** of the Sahel Adaptive Social Protection Program (SASPP), a **$1.3 billion** multi-country initiative **embedded in World Bank operations**. Generated evidence on what works in adaptive safety nets.

- Conducted a randomized impact evaluation of Mauritania's adaptive safety net program on household outcomes, producing evidence used by the SASPP team to refine program design and targeting.
- Synthesized evaluation findings into summary reports and internal presentations for the GIL, directly informing design and scaling decisions for social protection systems in climate-vulnerable regions.
- Collaborated with World Bank operational teams and researchers to integrate gender-sensitive monitoring into program design, strengthening alignment with gender-gap reduction objectives.

Centre d'Études et de Recherches sur le Développement International (CERDI)

Clermont-Ferrand, France

Ph.D. Research Fellow in Development Economics (Fixed-term contract)

Sept. 2023 – Mar. 2027

Conducted **applied microeconomic research** on poverty and social protection in Sub-Saharan Africa. Combined **experimental and quasi-experimental methods**, machine learning and satellite data to inform development policies.

- Produced subnational poverty maps for all Sub-Saharan African countries using predictive modeling and machine learning to estimate rates in non-surveyed areas, enabling targeted resource allocation.
- Collaborated with researchers and World Bank teams on impact evaluations of social protection programs, using causal inference, survey and satellite data to inform program design and scaling.
- Trained public officials and development practitioners in Stata, R and Python, with reproducible workflows and version control built into the course, enabling participants to produce and update their own policy analyses.

Aix-Marseille School of Economics (AMSE) Research Unit

Marseille, France

Economist – Data Scientist (Fixed-term contract)

Sept. 2022 – Aug. 2023

Produced **applied microeconomic research** on development in Sub-Saharan Africa. Integrated household surveys with **administrative and geospatial data** to generate evidence for inclusive growth and human capital policies.

- Supported researchers by harmonizing 12,500+ household observations from surveys covering 245 million people with administrative and geospatial data, producing poverty profiles to guide development programming.
- Contributed to research quantifying the impact of socio-cultural factors on poverty outcomes, applying causal inference to survey and text data to inform social protection and resilience policies.
- Developed an automated Python pipeline for cross-country data integration with reproducible workflows and version control, streamlining comparative analysis and cutting reporting time by 75%.

National Agency of Statistics and Demography of Senegal (ANSD) *Dakar, Senegal*

Economist – Statistician (Internship) *Mar. 2020 – Aug. 2020*

Assisted the **$40.5 million** World Bank-financed EHCVM household survey for national poverty measurement. Strengthened the statistical office's **field data collection** capacity under real-world operational constraints.

- Cleaned and analyzed 7,000 household records from the EHCVM survey, representative of Senegal's 16 million people, and estimated national poverty and inequality indicators used by the government for budget allocation.
- Developed and deployed the national household survey data collection application, moving it from prototype to field implementation in low-connectivity settings and improving data quality by 40%.
- Automated R scripts for poverty and inequality reporting, producing decision-oriented outputs that enabled near real-time monitoring and better targeting of resources.

Education

CERDI – Université Clermont Auvergne – CNRS – IRD *Clermont-Ferrand, France*

Ph.D. in Development Economics (expected March 2027) *Sept. 2023 – Mar. 2027*

- Thesis: Essays on Poverty, Nutrition, and Social Protection in Fragile and Conflict-Affected Settings.
- Supervisors: Pascale Phélinas (CERDI, UCA) and Jordan Loper (CERDI, UCA).

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MITx) *Massachusetts, USA (Online)*

MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Development Policy *Sept. 2023 – May 2025*

École Nationale de la Statistique et de l'Analyse de l'Information (ENSAI) *Rennes, France*

M.Eng. in Data Science and Applied Economics *Sept. 2020 – Nov. 2022*

Aix-Marseille School of Economics (AMSE) *Marseille, France*

M.Sc. in Theoretical and Empirical Economics *Sept. 2021 – Nov. 2022*

École Nationale de la Statistique et de l'Analyse Économique (ENSAE) *Dakar, Senegal*

B.Eng. in Applied Statistics and Data Science *Oct. 2016 – Aug. 2020*

Skills

Programming & Software *Level: advanced*

- Python, R, Stata, SQL, Git/GitHub, ArcGIS, QGIS, SurveyCTO, Survey Solutions, KoboToolbox, LaTeX.

Methods *Level: advanced*

- RCTs, difference-in-differences, matching, synthetic control, A/B tests, Random Forest, small-area estimation, NLP.

Data *Level: advanced*

- Surveys (DHS, MICS, LSMS, EHCVM), administrative, satellite data (night-time lights, land-cover), text data.

Honors & Awards

2026–2027 **WBG Africa Fellowship Program,** The World Bank Group, fellowship for African Ph.D. candidates.

2025–2026 **WBG Pioneers Program,** The World Bank Group, early-career talent program.

2023–2026 **Doctoral Grant,** CERDI, fully funded Ph.D. position.

2020–2022 **Merit Grant,** ENSAI, admission on academic record.

2016–2020 **Merit Grant,** ENSAE, competitive entrance examination.

Policy Reports

- *Malawi Poverty and Equity Assessment*, World Bank, Poverty & Equity Global Practice, forthcoming 2027.
- *Uganda Poverty and Equity Assessment*, World Bank, Poverty & Equity Global Practice, forthcoming 2027.
- *Informing the Refugee Policy Response in Uganda*, World Bank, Poverty & Equity Global Practice, forthcoming 2026.

Leadership

Association of Nigeriens in Clermont-Ferrand *Clermont-Ferrand, France*

President *Mar. 2024 – Present*

Conducted community initiatives and provided support for Nigerien residents in Clermont-Ferrand.

Election Committee of Lycée d'Excellence de Niamey *Niamey, Niger*

President *Oct. 2015 – Aug. 2016*

Ran the school-wide student elections, from rules to vote counting, with results accepted by all candidates.

References

- Lina Cardona Sosa (The World Bank): Senior Economist; lcardonasosa@worldbank.org; (+1) 202-948-4589.
- Julia Vaillant (The World Bank): Senior Economist; jvaillant@worldbank.org; (+1) 202-458-7717.
- Jordan Loper (UCA, CERDI): Associate Professor; Jordan.LOPER@uca.fr; (+33) 04-73-17-74-23.
- Pascale Phélinas (UCA, CERDI): Research Director; pascale.phelinas@uca.fr; (+33) 04-73-17-74-17.